

Mastering CSS Selectors: Class vs. ID

A guide to structuring and styling modern web elements with
precision and reusability.

01. Introduction

DEFINING THE VISUAL STRUCTURE

Styling HTML Elements

Unified Styling

Sometimes we want to style multiple elements the same way to maintain visual consistency across our interface. This is where **Classes** shine.

Unique Identification

Other times, we need to style only one specific, unique element on a page (like a Header or Logo). For this, we use **IDs**.

02. The Class Selector (.)

DESIGNED FOR REUSABILITY

Class Syntax & Usage



Syntax

Classes begin with a dot (`.`) in CSS. It allows you to group multiple elements under one style.



Example Rule

```
.highlight {  
  color: blue;  
  font-weight: bold;  
}
```



Multi-Use

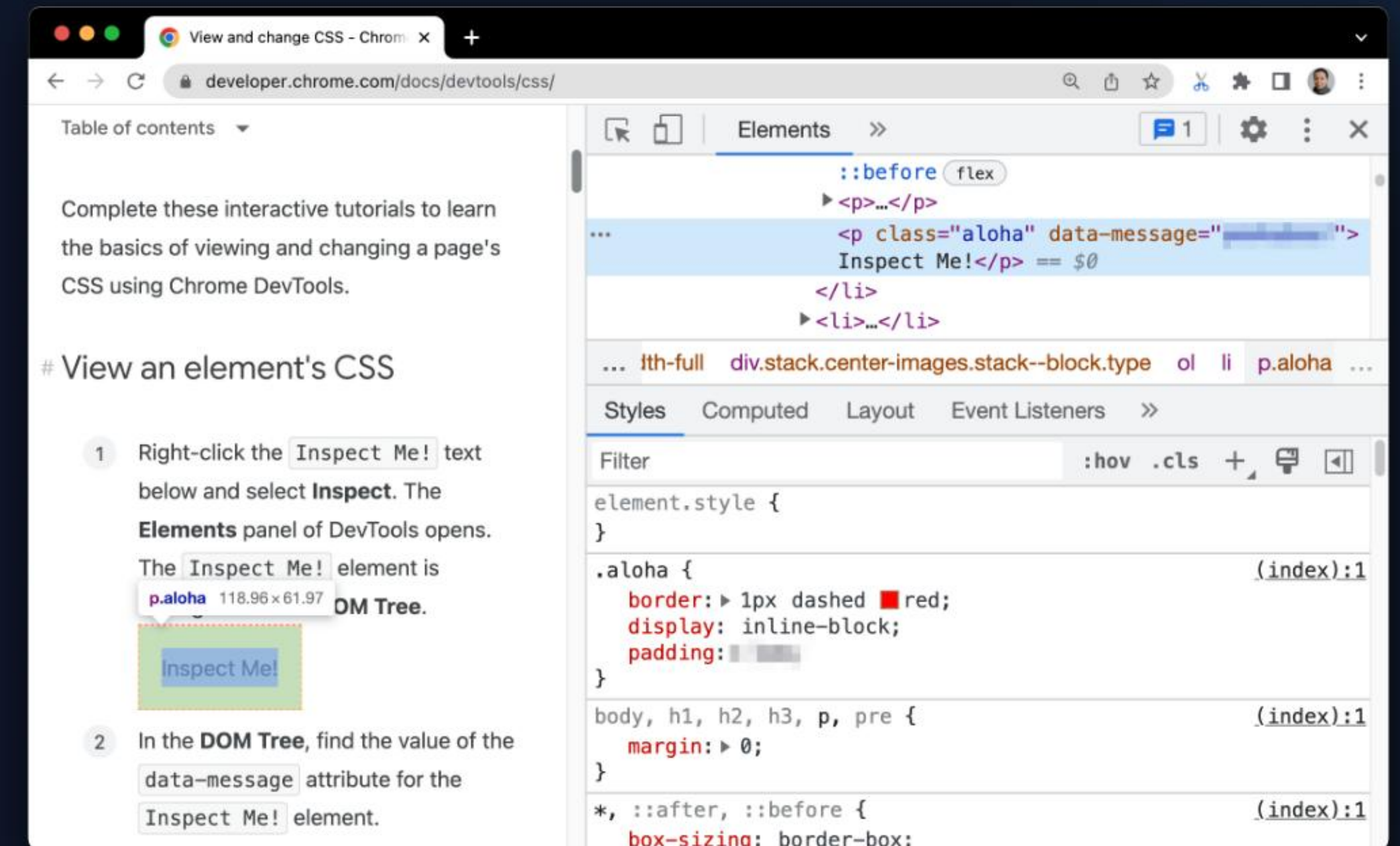
Applied in HTML using the `class` attribute. One class can style many paragraphs, headers, and divs simultaneously.

Applying Classes in HTML

Welcome to CSS!

Learning is fun.

Result: All elements sharing the class receive the same blue and bold styling instantly.



The Efficiency of Reusability

1

Rule for Infinite Elements

Why Use Classes?

Instead of styling every paragraph manually, you define one rule like `.important`. You can then apply it to thousands of elements. Changes are made in **one place**, updating the entire site instantly.

03. The ID Selector (#)

DESIGNED FOR UNIQUENESS

ID Syntax & Uniqueness



Syntax

IDs begin with a hash (#) in CSS. It targets one—and only one—unique element per page.



Example Rule

```
#header {  
  background: navy;  
  color: white;  
  padding: 20px;  
}
```



HTML Implementation

```
My Website
```

```
My Website
```


When to Use IDs?

IDs are ideal for structural sections that appear only once on a webpage:

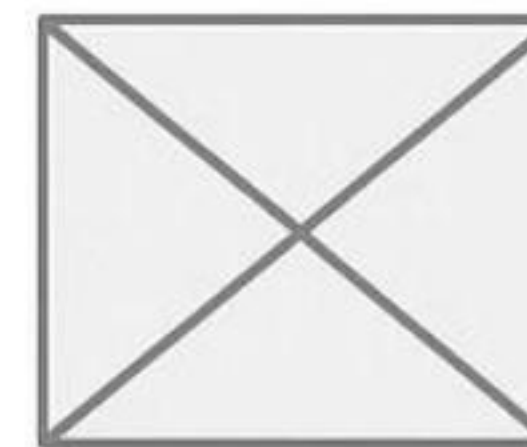
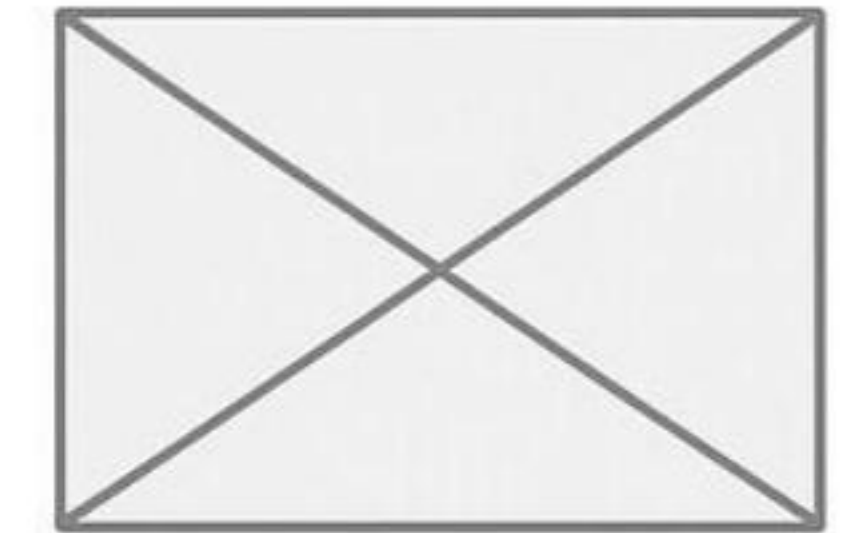
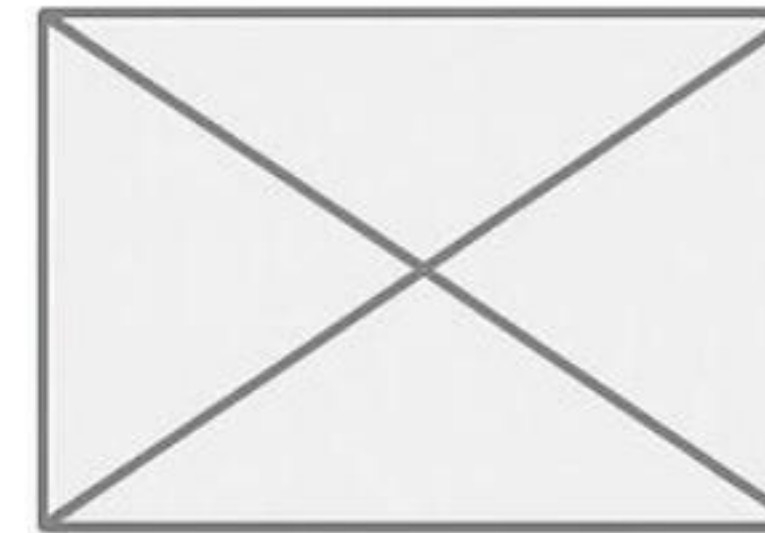
- > **Site Header** & Main Navigation
- > **Primary Logo** Branding
- > **Jump Link** Targets (Anchor tags)
- > **Footer** Section of the document

HEADLINE

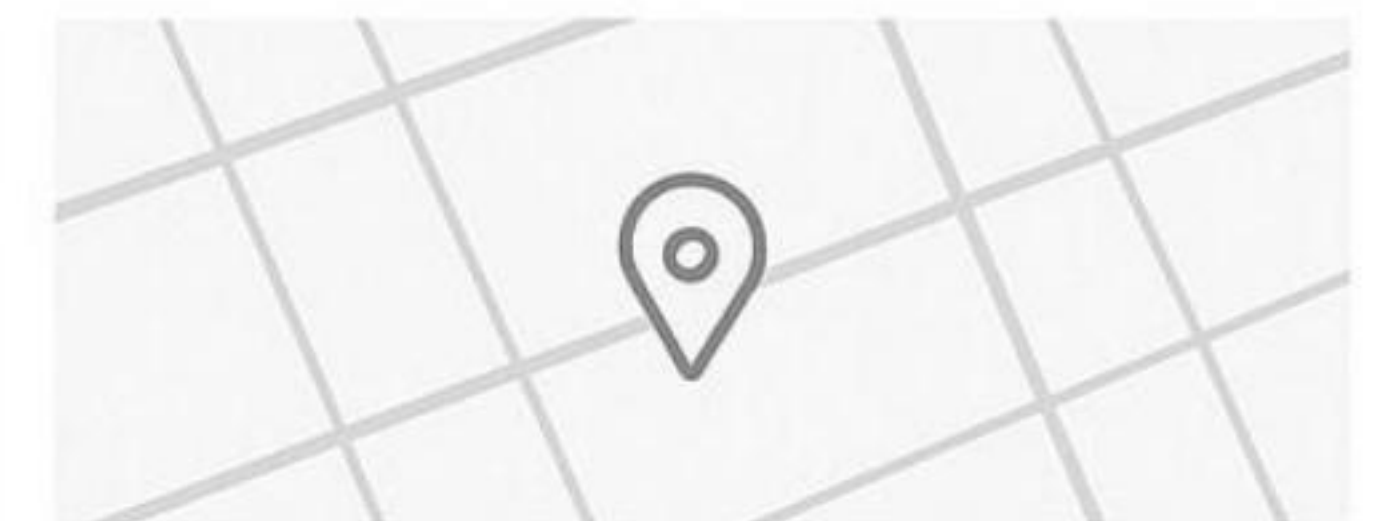
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Class vs. ID: Key Differences

Feature	Class (.)	ID (#)
Primary Use	Multiple elements	One unique element
Reusability	High (many times)	None (only once)
HTML Attribute	<code>class="name"</code>	<code>id="name"</code>
Specificity	Lower Strength	Higher Strength (Overrides Class)

Recap & Questions

"Use classes for styling groups, IDs for identifying unique elements."

Ready to style your first webpage?

Image Sources



<https://developer.chrome.com/static/docs/devtools/css/image/highlighted-element-8f4f3524bfa5c.png>

Source: developer.chrome.com



<https://www.godaddy.com/resources/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/website-wireframe-services.jpg?size=3840x0>

Source: www.godaddy.com